PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #63 · ABUSE

“If I tell someone, they won’t believe me, or they will blame me.”

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Where it often comes from

Many people stay quiet because they expect disbelief or blame. Sometimes that fear comes from already having been dismissed. The lie says that telling anyone will fail: they will not believe you, or they will make it your fault. Some people are unsafe to tell. That does not mean there is no one who can hear you. You choose who, and how much. A counselor is one place to start, and you can stop whenever you need to. If you are not safe right now, call 911. You can also call the National Domestic Violence Hotline at 1-800-799-7233. If a child is being hurt, call Childhelp at 1-800-422-4453. A counselor can help you at a pace that is safe. You do not have to do this alone, or all at once.

What Scripture teaches

The Lord is near the brokenhearted. He does not begin with an interrogation. Believers are told to carry one another’s burdens and to weep with those who weep. God binds up the brokenhearted. You can cast this fear on Him because He cares. These verses do not force you to disclose. They say that being heard is possible, and that disbelief from one person is not the verdict of God or of every person.

> *“The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit”* (Psalm 34:18).

Also see

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

> “Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep” (Romans 12:15).

> “The Spirit of the Lord GOD is on Me, because the LORD has anointed Me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent Me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives and freedom to the prisoners” (Isaiah 61:1).

> “Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you” (1 Peter 5:7).

Common self-statements

- No one will believe me.
- They will say I caused it.
- I should keep quiet so I am not put on trial.
- If I cannot prove it, it does not count.
- Telling will only make me the problem.
- Even God would take their side.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Deciding in advance that every listener will fail you.
- Overgeneralization: Turning one dismissal into “no one will believe me.”
- Mind reading: Knowing what a safe person would say before you ask.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Either everyone believes every detail or telling is pointless.

Challenging questions

- Who actually dismissed me, and have I made them stand for everyone?

- What would “a safe listener” need to be like?
- Do I have to prove the whole story before I am allowed to say I was hurt?
- What is the smallest true sentence I would be willing to try, and with whom?
- What does God do with the brokenhearted while people argue?
- What stop signal do I want with my counselor?

Truth summary

> Some people may not believe me, and that does not mean no one will. I can choose a safe person, say only what I want, and stop.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Help
- Loneliness
- Love, By God
- Friendship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Suffering
- Prayer

What does a mentally healthy Christian look like?



From *Christlike: Walking the Walk* by Dr. Brian Campbell. A portrait, verse by verse, of how a mentally healthy Christian thinks, feels, and lives.

Read excerpts from “The Mentally Healthy Christian” (with every Scripture written out)

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Truth Be Told — Matthew West featuring Carly Pearce
Truth can be told to a safe person. Not every listener is a courtroom.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
God's people are called to come near, not to cross-examine the wounded.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God does not walk out when the story is hard to hear.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
You can bring the fear of not being believed to God first.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, what is one step I could take today?"

My Plan for Replacing "If I tell someone, they won't believe me, or they will blame me."

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I tell someone, they won't believe me, or they will blame me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who actually dismissed me, and have I made them stand for everyone?
- ☐ What would "a safe listener" need to be like?
- ☐ Do I have to prove the whole story before I am allowed to say I was hurt?
- ☐ What is the smallest true sentence I would be willing to try, and with whom?
- ☐ What does God do with the brokenhearted while people argue?
- ☐ What stop signal do I want with my counselor?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Some people may not believe me, and that does not mean no one will. I can choose a safe person, say only what I want, and stop.
- ☐ One person not believing me is not everyone.
- ☐ I get to choose who hears me.
- ☐ I do not have to tell the whole story to be believed about the fact that I was hurt.
- ☐ God already knows, and He is near.
- ☐ A counselor can hear me at my pace.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 34:18
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ Romans 12:15
  "Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When you were sure you would not be believed: Each day, write down one moment when telling felt like walking into blame. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 34:18 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord is near me. I do not have to convince everyone before I am allowed to speak.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Help" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone. If you are not safe right now, call 911 or 1-800-799-7233.

- [ ] Do not start with the hardest listener. With your counselor, name one person who might be safe, or decide the counselor is the first hearer.
- [ ] Agree on a stop. Before any conversation, decide the sentence you will use to pause.
- [ ] Practice one sentence that does not include graphic detail: "I was hurt, and I need you to believe that."
- [ ] If telling is not safe yet, you do not have to. Call 911 or 1-800-799-7233 if you are in danger now.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I tell someone, they won't believe me, or they will blame me.": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A time I was heard
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I tell someone, they won't believe me, or they will blame me~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I expect disbelief and blame. Be near me. Give me one safe person, a slow pace, and the freedom to speak or to wait. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.